

THE BLACK PANTHER

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1969 Memo Revealed At Fred Hampton Murder Trial

HOOVER ORDERED F.B.I. TO SABOTAGE FREE BREAKFAST PROGRAM



The rationale of the FBI in 1969 for its attempts to destroy the BPP's Free Breakfast Program (above) was that the program "represents the best and most influential activity" of the Party.

(Chicago, Ill.) - A confidential three-page COINTELPRO document read to the six-member civil jury at the Fred Hampton murder trial here reveals that late FBI Director J. Edgar Hoover considered the Black Panther Party's Free Breakfast Program for Schoolchildren a "threat" and ordered covert counterintelligence operations against this Survival Program and its supporters.

According to a May, 1969, memo sent by Hoover to more than two dozen FBI offices, the BPP Free Breakfast Program "represents the best and most influential activity going for the BPP and as such is potentially the greatest threat to efforts by authorities to neutralize the BPP and destroy what it stands for."

The reading of this previously undisclosed memo into the court record, plus the following developments, have highlighted the trial in recent weeks:

- Orders by trial judge Joseph Sam Perry that the FBI turn over even more illegally withheld COINTELPRO documents;

- Disclosures that Chicago FBI agents lied to their Washington, D.C., superiors concerning un-Constitutional wiretaps on phone conversations between Fred Hampton and his attorneys; and

- The removal, by U.S. Attorney Sam Skinner of his top aide from a probe of government agents on his staff who withheld important COINTELPRO evidence from plaintiffs in the \$47.7 million case.

On trial before the middle-aged jury of five
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